

Most surprising:

UPI fraudsters specifically target **Tier-2 city students** during exam season with "fake refund" scams. In 2025, students lost ₹300 crore—more than any demographic—because we process 50-100 daily UPI transactions (canteen, Xerox, cab bookings) but rarely report within the critical 1-hour window. Most wait 2-3 days, losing 90% recovery chances.

Habit I'm changing: Biometric UPI lock on EVERY app.

Previously used only pattern lock; now PhonePe/Google Pay require fingerprint for each transaction (30 seconds extra but 95% safer). Also saved **1930 helpline** as speed dial #1 and screenshot suspicious WhatsApp messages immediately. This simple 1-minute daily habit prevents most frauds